Associate practice questions — set 2

10 free questions for the Claude Certified Associate – Foundations exam (CCAO-F). The correct option and its reasoning appear under each question — read them through, or cover the answer block and treat it as a timed self-check.

Question 1 **Product and Model Selection**

A user needs careful reasoning over a complex strategic trade-off where answer quality matters more than latency or price. Which model family is the best starting point?

A. Haiku solely because it is fastest for now.

B. Opus, followed by evaluation against the task's quality requirements.

C. Any model without testing because model choice never matters.

D. A connector instead of a model for now.

Correct answer: B

The guide expects model choice to align with complexity, quality, speed, and cost; Opus is the quality-oriented starting point here.

Question 2 **Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use**

A finance associate pastes unreleased quarterly results into a personal Claude account, contrary to company policy. What is the primary issue?

A. The prompt was too short in this specific situation.

B. The associate did not request an artifact for now.

C. Sensitive business data was handled outside the organization's approved controls.

D. Quarterly data cannot be analyzed by any AI system.

Correct answer: C

Governance begins with approved environments and data-handling rules, not prompt quality.

Question 3 **Output Evaluation and Validation**

Claude cites three web pages in a research note. What should the reviewer do to validate the most important conclusion?

A. Count the number of citations as the basis for the next workflow decision.

B. Assume links guarantee grounding and use that result to guide the team's next action.

C. Ask Claude whether it fabricated anything and accept its reply in this specific situation.

D. Open the relevant sources and confirm that they directly support the conclusion in context.

Correct answer: D

Source presence is insufficient; the cited material must actually entail the claim.

Question 4 **Workflow Integration and Solution Design** **Select all that apply**

A claims team wants Claude to draft case summaries inside its existing review process. Which two design choices best support responsible integration?

A. Insert the draft before the existing adjuster approval step for now.

B. Let drafts trigger payments without review in this specific situation.

C. Capture corrections so the team can evaluate and improve the workflow.

D. Measure success only by the number of summaries produced for now.

Correct answer: A, C

Placing Claude before approval augments rather than bypasses the accountable decision. Explanation for C: Correction data supports evaluation and iteration after integration.

Question 5 **Troubleshooting and Optimization**

After a prompt change, accuracy improves but processing time doubles. What should the team do next?

A. Keep it because one metric improved and use that result to guide the team's next action.

B. Compare the new result against explicit accuracy and efficiency targets before deciding whether to keep it.

C. Revert it because latency changed at all as the basis for the next workflow decision.

D. Change the model and prompt simultaneously without recording results as the next step in practice.

Correct answer: B

Optimization requires judging trade-offs against defined success measures.

Question 6 **Prompting and Task Execution**

Claude is asked to analyze a proposal but receives no evaluation criteria. What should be added?

A. A request to be more intelligent in this specific situation.

B. A list of decorative adjectives as the next step in practice.

C. A rubric describing the dimensions, evidence standard, and expected recommendation format.

D. An instruction to avoid all uncertainty in this specific situation.

Correct answer: C

A rubric turns an open-ended judgment into a structured, assessable task.

Question 7 **Configuration and Knowledge Management**

Team members use a Project for recurring contract reviews, but each person gives Claude different basic instructions. What configuration change would improve consistency?

A. Store the instructions only in one employee's memory in this specific situation.

B. Ask every user to improvise a prompt as the next step in practice.

C. Upload more contracts without defining the review task in this specific situation.

D. Add shared Project instructions covering the common role, process, boundaries, and output format.

Correct answer: D

Shared Project instructions establish repeatable baseline behavior for recurring work.

Question 8 **Output Evaluation and Validation**

A product brief includes every requested heading but contradicts itself about the launch date. Which quality dimension failed?

A. Internal consistency.

B. Visual polish only.

C. Audience selection only.

D. File naming.

Correct answer: A

Conflicting dates within one response are an internal consistency defect even when the structure is complete.

Question 9 | **Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use** | **Select all that apply**

A public-sector team is considering Claude for citizen-benefit eligibility decisions. Which two questions should be answered before deployment?

A. Can the interface use the agency's colors? for now.

B. What law, policy, and appeal requirements govern the decision?

C. Can Claude produce a confident answer every time?

D. Which decisions require accountable human judgment and review?

Correct answer: B, D

Regulatory and policy duties determine whether and how the use case may proceed. Explanation for D: Human accountability and review are essential for consequential eligibility decisions.

Question 10 | **Workflow Integration and Solution Design**

A pilot produces good drafts, but users copy data between three tools and frequently lose version history. What solution-design issue should be addressed?

A. The color of Claude's interface for now.

B. The number of adjectives in prompts.

C. The handoffs, system integration, and record-of-work requirements.

D. The model name alone for now.

Correct answer: C

A useful solution must fit operational handoffs and preserve required records, not merely generate good text. END OF FLASH DRILL

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